THE HAPPINESS ISSUE

SEASONED WITH SAFETY

Serving safe street food to its patrons, the Kankaria Lake food hub **has become a model to emulate** across the country

By SONALI ACHARJEE



In 2018, the 15th century Kankaria Lake in Ahmedabad became the country's first 'clean street food hub', certified so by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI). The area has 60-odd vendors serving extensive fare—pav bhaji, samosa, dhokla, panipuri, bhelpuri, dabeli, khichu, ice cream, coffee, and so on—to around 12 million people annually, many of whom throng it during festivals and the Kankaria Carnival held every December last week.

Taking a cue from Kankaria Lake and following a positive response to the 'clean street food hub' certification, the Union health ministry, in collaboration with the Union ministry of housing and urban affairs, last year wrote to all states and Union Territories to develop 100 such food streets in 100 districts across the country. These streets will be cleaned up and provided with proper sewage and waste disposal systems. States and UTs will receive financial assistance of Rs 1 crore to develop each of these streets. The funds will come through the National Health Mission on the condition that FSSAI guidelines are followed for standard branding of all these food hubs. The government is also investing in training the hawkers in hygiene and food hazard guidelines, independent third-party audits, and certification of various streets under the Eat Right India movement.

Street food has been an integral part of Indian society

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HAPPINESS QUOTIENT

↘ Sixty-odd vendors at Kankaria Lake, certified as India's first 'clean street food hub', have been serving unadulterated food in a hygienic environment to 12 million people every year

↘ The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India plans 100 such food streets across 100 districts. The Centre will provide Rs 1 crore each to set them up

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